

Monthly Operating Cost Estimate

Vercel · WordPress/WooCommerce · Firebase Storage

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This estimate outlines Longlife Digital's recurring website services and payment-processing costs. All amounts are in USD, before tax. Three usage scenarios show how the budget changes with sales, file downloads, email volume and AI assistant activity.

1. Estimated monthly website budget

Cost category	Low activity	Launch	Growth
Website services, including usage reserve	\$96.64	\$112.19	\$234.74
Payment processing on example sales	\$35.00	\$175.00	\$875.00
Total service and transaction budget	\$131.64	\$287.19	\$1,109.74

Usage assumptions

Monthly workload	Low activity	Launch	Growth
Successful domestic-card orders	20	100	500
Monthly sales / \$50 average order	\$1,000	\$5,000	\$25,000
Files stored / downloaded (GiB)	10 / 25	25 / 100	100 / 500
AI assistant replies	500	2,000	10,000
Combined emails / stored contacts	500 / 100	2,500 / 250	4,500 / 500
Vercel paid seats / business mailbox	2 / 1	2 / 1	2 / 1

Launch example: \$112.19 in website services + \$175 in payment fees for 100 orders totaling \$5,000 = \$287.19 per month.

The scenarios illustrate possible usage rather than forecast revenue. Website service totals include a reserve for Vercel overages; actual invoices depend on consumption. Existing subscriptions can satisfy the listed requirements and should be counted only once.

Fixed and recurring service costs

Fixed means a recurring plan or license at the selected tier. Mixed means a fixed base plus possible usage charges. Annual renewals are shown as a monthly budgeting equivalent; promotions and free trials are excluded.

2. Hosting, software and business essentials

Item / category	Cost type	Monthly cost	Billing basis / scope
Vercel Pro [S1–S2]	Mixed	\$40/month	\$20 platform fee includes one deploying seat and \$20 usage credit; a second paid seat adds \$20.
WordPress hosting: Kinsta [S3]	Mixed	\$35–\$50/month	Reference tiers: Single 20GB at \$35; Single 40GB at \$50. Growth uses \$50. Monthly billing; final tier depends on store capacity.
WordPress / WooCommerce core + Stripe plugin [S4–S5]	Fixed	\$0	Core software and the official payment gateway extension are free. Hosting and payment-processing charges are listed separately.
Primary .co domain [S13]	Annual fixed	\$3.79/month equivalent	\$45.48 annual renewal benchmark. Actual renewal follows the chosen registrar; applicable fees and taxes are additional.
Business mailbox [S12]	Per user	\$7/month	One Google Workspace Starter user, one-year commitment, billed monthly. Existing email service can replace this line.
Transactional + newsletter email [S10]	Tiered fixed	\$9/month	Brevo Starter entry tier: up to 5,000 combined sends and 500 stored contacts. All scenarios stay within both limits.
SSL, baseline security, WP backups [S3]	Included	\$0 extra	The reference host includes SSL, a web application firewall and daily WordPress backups. Firebase files use a separate backup process.
Firebase Hosting / Cloud Functions	Not used	\$0	Vercel hosts the storefront and planned API functions. No duplicate Firebase hosting plan.

Fixed/tiered baseline: \$94.79 per month with \$35 WordPress hosting, or \$109.79 with \$50 hosting. Storage, AI usage, the overage reserve and payment-processing fees complete the monthly budget.

The budget includes two Vercel paid team accounts. One paid account reduces the estimate by \$20 per month; read-only viewers are free. WordPress staff accounts do not each require a Vercel account. Kinsta provides a pricing benchmark; final provider selection remains open.

Variable cloud and AI usage

Variable costs depend on actual consumption. This model uses a new Firebase Storage bucket, Standard storage in us-central1, eligible US-region free allowances, and mainly US downloads. Legacy buckets and other regions can have different charges. [S6–S8, S15]

3. Metered rates and assumptions

Service	Cost type	Published rate / estimate basis
 Firebase Storage [S6–S8] 	Variable	About \$0.02/GiB-month after 5 GiB; eligible outbound transfer: \$0.12/GiB after 100 GiB/month.
 Storage operations [S7–S8] 	Variable	After 5,000 Class A / 50,000 Class B monthly free operations: \$0.005 / \$0.0004 per 1,000, respectively.
 Vercel functions/builds [S1] 	Variable	\$20 usage credit is included in Pro. The scenarios allow \$0 / \$10 / \$40 for additional usage; these reserves are estimates, not fixed provider charges.
 AI: Claude Haiku 4.5 [S14] 	Variable	\$1 per million input tokens + \$5 per million output tokens. Model 2,000 input + 300 output tokens per reply: \$0.0035.
 Optional Firestore 	Variable	\$0 in these scenarios. If added, charges will depend on database reads, writes and storage.

Monthly usage model

Usage category	Low activity	Launch	Growth
 Storage + download + operations 	\$0.10	\$0.40	\$49.95
 AI assistant 	\$1.75	\$7.00	\$35.00
 Vercel overage budget reserve 	\$0.00	\$10.00	\$40.00
 Combined variable allocation 	\$1.85	\$17.40	\$124.95

Growth storage example: $(100 - 5) \times \$0.02 + (500 - 100) \times \$0.12 + \$0.045 \text{ operations} = \49.945 , rounded to \$49.95/month. A 1 GiB file downloaded 500 times uses 500 GiB.

Operations assumed: 500/5,000, 2,000/20,000 and 10,000/100,000 Class A/B requests across the three scenarios. Free allowances must be available to this billing account. Stored totals must include retained versions and backup copies. Firebase Storage requires Blaze billing; free allowances do not mean a Spark plan is sufficient. Longer chat histories or added retrieval/tool calls increase AI costs; no caching discounts are assumed.

Payments and communications

4. Payment processing: tied to sales

Scenario	Amount processed	Transactions	Variable fees
Low activity	\$1,000	20	\$35.00
Launch	\$5,000	100	\$175.00
Growth	\$25,000	500	\$875.00

- Stripe US standard pricing is 2.9% + \$0.30 per successful domestic-card transaction, with no standard monthly payment-processing fee. WooCommerce adds no core-platform revenue share. [S4, S9]
- Formula: monthly fees = 0.029 × total amount processed + \$0.30 × successful transactions. The scenarios assume one payment per order, domestic cards, USD and no separate taxes/shipping added to the stated sales.

Other payment and commerce charges

- International cards add 1.5%; currency conversion adds 1% when required. Alternative payment methods, disputes, refunds and additional Stripe products can affect the final charge. Account-specific rates apply. [S9]
- Recurring service billing may require a paid subscription extension. Automated tax, online-course software and domain escrow/transfer services are optional additions whose costs depend on the products selected.

5. Email plans and capacity

Email option	Cost type	Price	Limit / treatment
Budgeted: Brevo Starter [S10]	Tiered fixed	\$9/month	One combined allowance for newsletter and transactional sends; 5,000 sends / 500 contacts. Included once in totals.
Alternative: Brevo Free [S10]	Free / limited	\$0	300 sends/day. Suitable only if campaigns and order messages can stay within the daily cap.
Alternative: Resend [S11]	Mixed	\$0 or \$20/month	Free: 3,000 transactional emails/month, 100/day. Pro: 50,000/month; \$0.90 per additional 1,000. Newsletter service separate.
Business mailbox [S12]	Per user	\$7/month	Workspace mailbox handles staff correspondence. It serves a different purpose from automated delivery.

Brevo is counted once. Higher contact/send volumes or optional features may require a higher tier. Alternatives replace the Brevo allowance. Service accounts remain under Longlife Digital ownership.

Optional services and billing schedule

The baseline covers the services listed in the monthly budget. The options below allow capacity or features to expand as business requirements change. They are not included in the scenario totals.

6. Optional service additions

Item	Cost type	Price or billing basis
More frequent WordPress backups [S3]	Fixed add-on	\$20/month for backups every six hours; \$100/month for hourly backups. Daily backups are included in the reference hosting plan.
Premium plugins, automated tax, online courses	License / usage	Pricing depends on the selected service and plan. No premium extension is included in the baseline.
Additional mailbox [S12]	Per account	+\$7/month for each Workspace Starter account with a one-year commitment.
Additional Vercel team account [S1]	Per account	+\$20/month for each additional paid account. Read-only access is free.
Additional domains and advertising	Annual / variable	Only the primary .co renewal is included. Resale-domain renewals and advertising spend depend on the portfolio and campaigns.

Billing schedule

Expense	Budget treatment	Payment schedule
Primary .co domain [S13]	\$3.79/month equivalent	\$45.48 annual renewal; the monthly equivalent spreads the annual cost across the budget.
Workspace Starter [S12]	\$7/account/month	Billed monthly with a one-year commitment. A flexible plan may cost more.
Hosting and email plans [S1, S3, S10]	Monthly subscription	Regular monthly rates are used; introductory offers and free trials are not included.
Usage and card processing [S7, S9, S14]	Variable	Charges depend on actual consumption and successful payments.

All figures exclude applicable taxes on provider invoices. Retained file versions and backup copies count toward storage usage. WordPress hosting backups do not automatically include files held in Firebase.

Budget assumptions and sources

Provider prices were checked on September 10, 2026 using official pricing pages and documentation. Source identifiers beside each cost item correspond to the links below. Estimates use standard ongoing prices, without temporary promotions.

How to use this estimate

- Final costs depend on the existing subscriptions, registrar, team accounts, payment methods, file sizes, download volume and email contact list. The scenarios provide a starting budget until actual usage is available.
- Annual renewals are shown as monthly equivalents. Domain renewal is $\$45.48 \div 12 = \3.79 per month. The \$7 Workspace rate requires a one-year commitment.
- Usage alerts and regular billing reviews help track changes. The Vercel reserve is a budget allowance, not a spending cap. Hosting capacity depends on store activity and API traffic as well as website visits.

Source register — clickable references

- S1 Vercel Pro: platform, seats, credit and usage
- S2 Vercel pricing: commercial plan eligibility
- S3 Kinsta: monthly hosting, annual billing and backup options
- S4 WooCommerce: free core platform
- S5 WooCommerce: official Stripe extension
- S6 Firebase pricing: current and legacy storage buckets
- S7 Google Cloud Storage: storage, requests and data transfer
- S8 Google Cloud: regional free-tier allowances
- S9 Stripe: US standard payment pricing
- S10 Brevo: plan prices, email volumes and contact limits
- S11 Resend: transactional email plans
- S12 Google Workspace: Starter pricing and commitment
- S13 Namecheap: .co renewal pricing
- S14 Anthropic: Claude Haiku 4.5 API pricing
- S15 Firebase: Blaze billing requirement for Storage